

INVESTOR & LENDER DECK — SEPTEMBER 2026

Limepaper

Tree-free, water-free "stone paper" made from Rajasthan's marble waste — a packaging and stationery substrate for a market moving away from wood pulp and single-use plastic.

Kishangarh / Rajsamand, Rajasthan

Manufacturing — Stone Paper

Pre-plant / Pre-revenue

THE PROBLEM

Two problems that solve each other

Packaging buyers need an alternative

- India's single-use-plastic restrictions and FMCG ESG mandates are pushing procurement toward substitutes
- Wood-pulp paper carries ~200 tonnes of water and ~2,900 kWh of energy per tonne — a real cost and ESG liability
- Wood prices have risen ~88% recently; India pays a premium vs. international buyers

Rajasthan has a waste crisis, not a resource

- Kishangarh's marble-slurry dumping yard takes a truck roughly every 10 minutes at peak
- CPCB and NGT have flagged groundwater and soil contamination from this slurry
- Processors actively want offtake — feedstock is a liability looking for a buyer, not a scarce input

THE PRODUCT

Stone paper, made near the mine mouth

≈80% ground limestone/marble waste (CaCO_3) + ≈18% HDPE + ≈2% additives — compounded and extruded into sheet, no water, no bleach, no pulping.



MARKET OPPORTUNITY

A small, fast-growing category with a thin field

**\$1.06bn →
\$1.34bn**

Global stone paper, 2026→2031 (4.9% CAGR)

**\$58.7m →
\$122.9m**

India stone paper, 2024→2033 (8.8% CAGR —
fastest in APAC)

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Branded India competitor (Ston2pack) — dormant
since 2022–23

Packaging is the largest global demand segment (37.9% share); industrial labels & tags is the fastest-growing use case (7.6% CAGR); India's self-adhesive/label segment is its fastest-growing sub-category.

A captive position nobody else claims

Vertically integrated from day one

- In-house feedstock refining/micronizing — not buying pre-purified powder
- In-house extrusion + calendering
- In-house converting — notebooks, cartons on the same site
- Most competitors buy in pre-made sheet or pre-purified powder — we don't

The team

- Two founders, product/B2B sales/brand — digitally-native, energy-intensive execution
- A senior family member running factory-floor operations and vendor/landlord relationships
- ~4 years of hands-on carton-industry experience (2022–present) — a real credibility asset
- No large payroll, no outside equity spent yet — lean by construction, not by necessity

UNIT ECONOMICS

Roughly half the material cost of wood-pulp paper

COST ELEMENT (PER TONNE OUTPUT)	WOOD-PULP PAPER	STONE PAPER
Primary raw material	₹32,000–60,000	₹1,400–3,800
Binder / resin	Chemicals, ~5–10% of opex	₹16,900–21,800 (HDPE — largest single line)
Process water	~200 t/t + ETP burden	~0
Energy	~1,300–1,700 kWh/t electricity + steam	~700 kWh/t, no boiler stage
Illustrative all-in (materials + energy)	≈ ₹42,000–73,000+	≈ ₹24,000–32,000

Counter-intuitive finding: cheap local limestone lowers the bill but doesn't dominate it — HDPE resin, a national petrochemical commodity, is the larger cost line. The Rajasthan edge is really feedstock security, near-zero logistics, and the ESG/circular-economy story.

TWO REVENUE CHANNELS, ONE LINE

Raw substrate + finished branded goods



Sheet / roll stock



Notebooks



Cartons



Carry bags



Tags & labels

Channel 1 — Raw substrate

Wholesale sheet/roll to converters and brands. Thin per-unit margin, minimal conversion cost on our side. Primary Stage 1 plan, LOI-gated before equipment is ordered.

Channel 2 — Finished goods

10 SKUs under our own name. We capture the converting margin; we bear the converting capex and own the brand and sales relationship.

GO-TO-MARKET

B2B first, sequenced by how these buyers actually behave

SEGMENT	SEQUENCING	WHY
Corporate gifting	Year 1 — first revenue	Zero certification barrier, cash-flow bridge, not a moat
E-commerce mailers / cartons	Year 1	Direct fit for Channel 1 substrate sales
Industrial labels & tags	Year 1–2	Fastest-growing use case, high-margin, low-volume entry
FMCG packaging (ESG-driven)	Year 2, once track record exists	Requires technical qualification and reference accounts
Pharma	Year 3+	Multi-year vendor audit trail — not a year-one segment for a new vendor

Pre-sell before commissioning: 3–5 signed LOIs or pilot POs required before equipment is ordered.

What we're watching, and what we're doing about it

Not "plastic-free"

~18% of the product is HDPE, which only photodegrades — not biodegrades. "Tree-free, water-free" is the defensible claim; "plastic-free" is not, and we say so upfront rather than let a buyer discover it.

GST/HSN classification is open

Could be taxed as "plastic sheet" rather than "paper" — a material swing in margin. An advance ruling is a pre-condition before capital moves, not an afterthought.

The one India precedent went dormant

Ston2pack, the only branded India stone-paper player, has been quiet since 2022–23 under arguably better conditions than today. Diligence on why is our first task, before any other capital is spent.

Capital precedes revenue

Stage 1 capex is drawn before the plant sells anything. We've built hard gates — signed LOIs, vendor quotes, a debt-service model at 30/50/70% utilisation — before equipment is ordered.

Stage 1 is debt-financed — we are not raising equity right now

Stage 1 — ₹1.5cr, bootstrapped

- Collateral-backed term debt: ₹70L family shop (clear title) + ₹10L silver
- CGTMSE-guaranteed, no external equity
- Hard ceiling — no new borrowing until $\geq 50\%$ repaid from operations
- Two ring-fenced reserves: ₹10L salary buffer, ₹8L emergency

Stage 2 — ₹15cr for 10% equity

- Gated, not scheduled: 12+ months of real Stage 1 operating data
- 3–5 anchor B2B accounts with repeat purchases, not LOIs
- Debt serviced on schedule; GST/HSN resolved
- Sized against India's ₹17.2cr published 5 TPD turnkey benchmark

We evaluated an Antler India pre-seed application and declined it as currently scoped
— see next slide.

We looked at pre-seed equity, and said not yet

We ran a structured, adversarial review of an Antler India pre-seed application (~₹2–4cr for 9–11% equity) against our debt-financed Stage 1 plan. The finding: applying now would price the company at a valuation it hasn't earned yet, and convert a recoverable asset risk into permanent equity dilution and governance obligations — before our own governance structure is even finalized.

What we're doing instead

Confirming whether CGTMSE's own collateral-substitution mechanics can reduce our shop-pledge exposure — the actual problem outside equity would need to solve.

When this changes

A manufacturing-focused investor at a valuation grounded in comparable deals, or Stage 2's own gates being met on schedule, both reopen this conversation on our terms, not a program's.

18-MONTH ROADMAP

What happens, and when

MONTHS	MILESTONE
0–2	Diligence gates closed: competitor diligence, vendor quotes (incl. leasing terms), signed LOIs, GST/HSN ruling, bank shop valuation
2–4	Loan sanctioned, entity incorporated, PCB Consent to Establish, existing small loans closed
4–10	Feedstock refining + extrusion line installed; core converting line commissioned
10–12	First commercial production; conditional paper bag line if glue trial clears
12–18	Line running at increasing utilisation; repeat-order data tracked; debt service from operations begins

THE ASK

What we need from this conversation

If you're a lender

Sanction the Stage 1 term loan against the documented collateral package — ₹70L shop, ₹10L silver, CGTMSE guarantee — once our six pre-conditions close.

If you're a future investor

We're not raising equity today. Stay in touch for Stage 2, or reach out if you fund capital-intensive manufacturing at a valuation grounded in comparable deals — not a program-standard check.